- You can sign up for newsletters.
- You can see the latest book releases.
- You can have a look at the items you viewed on previous visits.
- You can read interviews with authors.

That’s a lot of complex functionality, and with so many books and authors at Manning, there must be a huge number of pages to maintain. Think of the work required to redesign the site to give it a new look, applying changes to all those countless pages!

A web development framework makes light of these complexities by providing prebuilt solutions to common tasks, so you can get on with building your application. Take the task of displaying the details of all those books, for example. Rather than having to create a page per book, a framework—like Razor Pages—will provide you with the capability of creating a template for displaying any book. It also includes placeholders, so the details of a specific book, such as its title, author, ISBN, and number of pages, can be fetched from a central store (e.g., a database) and plugged in on demand (much like how a mail merge document works). Now you only have one page to manage for all books instead of one page per book.

How about the task of managing user information? You will need some way to store this information and match it against login details provided by the user. You also need to provide a mechanism for identifying that the current user has already successfully logged in, so they don’t have to authenticate themselves again for every subsequent page they want to view. And you need to do all of this securely, employing acceptable levels of cryptography. Again, a good framework will provide these features for you. All you have to do is learn how the features work and plug them into your application,